Yes, Chef

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/48910750.

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Explicit

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

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by cabbageboy

Summary

It was a long dinner service.

Catra's throat is raw with the effort of giving orders and shouting tickets all night. Adora's exhausted body probably couldn't flip another filet if her life depended on it.

But when they get home?

Adora shows Catra just how lucky she felt to be her sous chef

Notes

I'm sorry this is so, so silly

Please read and enjoy!

“Blondie, I need two salmon and a trout.”

“Heard, Chef!” Echoes through the kitchen.

Skin sizzles in the oil as Adora carefully lays two salmon filets in a heated pan. Taking careful note of the time on her watch and then moving on to grab another from the stack of pans to her left, she prepares to make the popular trout dish that had been the star of their menu since the food critic’s visit last month. They called everything on the menu ‘inventive’ and ‘to die for,’ which was pretty on par for everything that Adora knew about Catra and everything that she knew about the restaurant.

The Tabby was a true hole in the wall, with an exclusive and minimalist menu that spoke to the simplicity and quality that Catra demanded of her food. It was one of the most popular spots downtown, though there was no signage out front to even give away that it was there. Simply a weather worn copper façade that carved out its space on the block. The entrance was right next to the 7-eleven on H, and one could easily pass it in favor of some of the more ostentatious restaurants and bars.

Catra didn’t want to be known for finery, like some of the pompous tools she’d met in her career. They had been dreaming of vast dining rooms with white silken table cloths, polished silverware and sparkling crystal, servers in bow ties and tuxedo jackets with tails. It was all very barf worthy stuff, listening to them drone on about the kind of fine dining restaurant they would have.

But she didn’t want any of that. She wanted a place that was comfortable, classy but understated. She wanted somewhere that people weren’t afraid to bring their kids, somewhere that catered to the families she knew lived in the area as well as the singles that frequented the bar. She didn’t want something that felt stuffy, that felt too good for itself. No, the ‘fine dining’ experience could be had without the awful sterility that came with that reputation. Everyone belonged in her restaurant.

Reputation was everything, and if there was one thing Catra actually wanted her reputation to speak to, it's her food.

Which, in Adora's opinion, was truly something else. (Everything about Catra was something else though).

"Alright, three apps to table thirteen; two scallops and a risotto."

"Yes, Chef. Two scallops and one risotto, Chef."

Adora flips the two salmon filets and tosses a pad of butter in to baste the trout. Lonnie, on apps, starts the risotto.

The kitchen was truly something to be proud of. Catra had overhauled the place upon buying it a few years ago. The renovation to the dining room was first, with the kitchen taken care of the following year. A double fryer, sixty inch range with more burners than Adora even knew how to utilize at once, a spacious walk in, and last but not least a prep area that rivaled some of the Michelin star restaurants Adora trained with in Paris. It was a place that everyone was proud to work. Then again, Adora would be proud to work anywhere for Catra.

Adora was proud of Catra in every lifetime, whether she owned a restaurant downtown or not.

"Adora, how much longer on table sixteen's fish?"

"Two minutes to the window, Chef."

"You gonna drink any water tonight?"

Adora rolls her eyes and picks up the pitcher on the counter, pouring herself a glass.

She makes eye contact as she takes a sip. But then she steps back, defeated, when she needs to take another long pull from the glass. Seems she was thirstier than she thought.

Adora ignores the smirk on Catra's face that she can just make out in the reflection of the polished sheet metal backsplash.

"Alright we're thirty seconds to the window with that salmon and trout. Kyle, you have my garnishes?"

"Garnishes up, Chef," The nervous boy says, bringing his garnish for the salmon and trout to the window. He hands the metal tray to Catra and she begins to plate the food.

"Hot behind you," Adora says firmly as she passes Catra and places the salmon and trout filets in their pans next to Catra. She carefully places the salmon on a bed of garlic mash, crispy skin side up, and sets a few spears of asparagus on top. Drizzling the creamy garlic butter around the pool of mash is the last step before the salmon goes to the window. Next for the trout, she takes the garnish of a spiced up classic. The harissa green beans almondine goes down first, with the trout on top, and dots of the carrot and parsnip puree around the plate.

Catra could plate her menu in her sleep. She'd dreamed of its flavors often enough, too.

"Perfect, these look beautiful. Keep it up," She says curtly, short and sweet and to the point when she was in the kitchen.

"Thank you, Chef," Adora and Kyle say together.

And in one swoop, Catra is putting up the salmon and trout dishes, hands coming back from the window with a new ticket, and they're on to the next table of entrees.

A knock disturbs Catra from her paperwork. Middle finger pushing thick black frames up her nose, she looks past the glare of her computer screen and to the door to the dining room.

Adora leans on the frame, chef jacket unbuttoned to reveal the white tank top underneath. Her form is striking, an imposing shadow stretching far into the room. The outline of her body,

strong and tall, makes Catra sigh in her office chair. There are a lot of things that cause Catra stress, but the one thing that could always fix the buzzing in her brain was the sight of her wife.

“Kitchen all cleaned up?”

“Yep. And the dining room is taken care of too,” Adora says, taking a step further. The sway of her hips distracts Catra enough for her to drop the paper in her hands and stand from her seat.

“Bar closed down?” She asks, taking a short step around the desk and planting her hands on Adora's hips. She turns, and Adora finds herself right next to the desk, being pushed down to sit on its edge.

“I made sure it was before Rogellio left. He’s got it under control.”

“Thank you. After service I got stuck doing bills and shit, so I didn’t have a chance to check back in with him.”

Catra wraps her arms around Adora’s neck. Hands work their way below the jacket to rub up and down between her neck and the rounds of her shoulders. Strong, sure hands come up to the small of Catra’s back and Adora pulls her closer between her legs.

“How was service for you?” Adora asks, pulling back the collar of Catra’s chef coat gingerly with a single finger to give her the access she needs. Pressing gentle kisses to Catra’s sharp collar bone and up her neck, Adora holds her beloved close and breathes her in, all of her.

The sweet smell of her lavender lotion, the sweat on her neck, the permeating fragrance of garlic and onion and oils. It was all there, but with that distinct scent that was all Catra, only Catra. Adora was addicted to it, to the smell of her, the feel of her. Adora holds her close and feels the swell in her chest, ever present when Catra was in her arms.

It’s silent for a beat, and in that moment the night really catches up with both of them. Adora slumps on the desk, but holds herself

up for Catra. And Catra wraps her arms around Adora's middle, bringing her close.

"Service was great. Everything the kitchen put out was really solid and it looks like the new specialty cocktails are popular. How was it for you?"

Adora hums.

"There was this really really hot distraction shouting at me all night and my brain could barely keep up with how fucking gorgeous she was and how much I wanted to close the kitchen and take her home."

Catra throws her head back in a laugh, but Adroa's lips on her neck choke the sound and make her shudder.

"Well, I'm glad you held it together for me because I don't think we'd have a very good reputation if we closed up shop every time you wanted to take me home."

"Baby, if I had you home every time I wanted to we wouldn't even open in the first place."

Catra's eyes had closed when she felt lips on her heated flesh, but they flutter open when they feel the emotion in Adora's voice. There was something there, strained and tense, and Catra was dying to get home and draw cursing breaths through those pouty lips.

"Well, there was this sexy cook that kept making bedroom eyes at me all night, and she served me the best homemade gnocchi I've ever had. And I'd be lying if I didn't say that I've been waiting for her to walk in here all night and take me home with her," Catra whispers, tongue peeking out to lick her lips before drawing one between her teeth, waiting for an answer.

The heat of the body holding her close comforts Catra, lures her in and traps her in this realm where only they were allowed, their special place. A place they could always come home to. It hid

there, with them, always. Adora held it in clawing fingertips that pressed into Catra's spine. Catra's heart swelled with the reminder every time those blunt nails dug into her skin. It was a feeling that Catra kept close to her heart, but at the ready for when Adora needed it.

They were home, no matter where they were, as long as they were together. As long as Adora could draw her love close, as long as Catra could stand on her tiptoes and peck a kiss to her beloved's dried, sweaty forehead, they would have their home with them.

But Catra rather liked the idea of being taken back to their other home, the one they shared, the one on 42nd street, three blocks away.

"Let's go, yeah?" Catra pulls back from Adora's embrace, and shivers with the loneliness her heart feels at being pulled apart. But she grabs Adora's hand and her packed shoulder bag and pulls her out of the office. The office locks smoothly behind them, and they're cutting through the dining room to the front door, Catra tugging Adora's hand the whole way.

"Everyone out?" She asks, before they get to the front of the restaurant.

They saunter past the bar, black subway tile with gold-flecked black grout shimmers in the dimness of the closed dining room. Just hours ago the staff were hustling about with trays of drinks and food, boisterous customers laughing at the bar. Now, the lacquer finished mahogany high tops almost glow as they walk by.

"Yes Chef, I cut the rest of the cooks and the wait staff once I checked everything over."

Having a cook that was also a partial owner had its perks. Catra got to trust the clean up for the night to Adora, trusting the delegation of tasks to her most trusted person, while she handled the overwhelming paperwork that came with being a small

business. The restaurant had only been open a few years, but she and Adora had trained in culinary school together and she knew what the other woman was capable of.

Catra's thoughts drifted back to that time in her life, where she was fighting to be the best in their class, the rookie with a chip on her shoulder. Adora was the underdog that everyone believed in, the one who trained in Parisian kitchens before making her way on a scholarship to one of the world's most renowned culinary academies. They raced in everything, competed with each other whenever they could, and one night when Catra was studying a couple of recipes Adora barged into the kitchen with all the gusto of someone determined to pass the pastry portion of their final.

Eyes met. Catra was off of her stool before she knew what she was doing and Adora was throwing her back against the door to the walk-in with the grace and gentle touch of a baby elephant learning to use its trunk for the first time.

They didn't get kicked out, because it didn't go further than a heated and forceful make out session, but they were warned that such a relationship between students wasn't to be tolerated in the kitchen.

So they giggled and held hands, pulling each other in turns back to Adora's apartment. It was there that they took their time with each other. Adora opened a nice bottle of red and used it to braise some short ribs she'd come across at a discount from the butcher. And while those were going in the pressure cooker, Catra had poured the rest of the bottle into two hefty glasses.

Wordlessly, they moved around the kitchen together, sipping their wine and trading kisses. At one point while Catra was mashing the freshly boiled potatoes, Adora came up behind her and wrapped her arms around Catra's body, holding her hands and helping sensually thrust the potato masher in her hand through the softness in the bowl. Maybe it was ridiculous to be so turned on by such a thing, but she kept her eyes trained on Adora's wrist the entire time, saw the strong ligaments strain against the twist of

her hand, and Catra had nearly passed out at the thought of those hands doing something to her too.

It didn't take long, maybe an hour to cook the short ribs and then have the instant pot naturally release its pressure. So they talked about anything and everything, drinking in knowledge of each other with more urgency than anything they'd ever studied.

Catra talked about her parents, the love of cooking with them and helping run their small cafe. It was just a few blocks up the street from where they would eventually land The Tabby, unbeknownst to either of them at the time. She had always been a local, though she did do a summer in Spain, working as a line cook in her mentor's restaurant and she was hooked on cooking, a dream formulating in her head of the restaurant she wanted to open.

Adora talked about cooking for her fellow foster kids, since she was the oldest and their foster mom made it home late from work most nights. Snacks after school turned into dinners, and dinners turned into family events. Later, when she found the mother that she was separated from, she would spend her money taking care of the woman instead of paying for her own education. She could just manage the move from New York out to train in Paris, but when she was accepted into culinary school, everything changed for her.

They both had a dream, and as they shared their meal that night, a candle on the center of the table and another empty bottle of wine on the kitchen counter, Catra and Adora decide that maybe, just maybe, they could make their dreams work together.

As their relationship grew, they got jobs after graduation at restaurants in the same city. Their wedding was a year later, and they opened The Tabby a year after that.

The door to The Tabby closes behind Adora, and Catra pulls the keys out of her pocket to lock up. When she's finished, she takes a look at the black and gold, the interior she can see through the

glass, and lets herself be proud for just a second at the life she built for herself, the thriving business she owned.

And then she feels a warm hand slide into her own, tugging her away and toward the other thing she's probably most proud of, their home. They walk hand in hand the few blocks back to their apartment.

As soon as the door shuts, Catra finds her back to it, manhandled and manipulated into the position Adora wants her in, with legs parted to accept the thigh that presses between them.

"Oh, baby, you've been thinking about this all night, haven't you?" Catra groans, panting as fingers slip below the waistband of her underwear and lips caress her neck.

Adora nods, breathing out a puff of hot air right onto Catra's exposed flesh, right where her neck met her collar bone, and she shivers with the feeling.

"Yes, Chef," Adora grunts out, pulling down Catra's pants and helping her out of them before unbuttoning Catra's chef coat.

Catra starts to pull it off of her shoulders, but Adora stops her with a hand to the base of her throat, pushing her back against the door again.

"The jacket stays on."

Catra can hardly stop herself from groaning again. She pants in shallow breaths as Adora's fingers explore her soft, silken flesh. Fingers hold her hips tight as Adora uses her strength and height as an advantage, pulling Catra up the door and to the very tips of her toes while that knee helps to hold her wife in place.

"Fuck, Adora, just like that," Catra says, winding her fingers into long hair and pulling the ponytail holder free just in time to feel fingers at the edge of her pussy, skirting around her labia. Catra almost sits on Adora's thigh where it rests between her legs, but she doesn't let herself seem too desperate, not yet, not this early.

She wants Adora to touch her more than she could ever convey, but this was something else, this was Adora's need to be a good little cook for her chef and give her the experience she needed, the love she deserved, the fun they both wanted after a serious night in the kitchen.

Work was work, and they loved that they got to be themselves at work. But being home? Being with each other? *In* each other?

Catra gasps when those fingers slide into her wetness, the softest part of her, the part that she only ever wanted to be for Adora. Another set of fingers pushes between her lips and into her waiting mouth, still open from her gasp and Adora unable to resist.

"Suck them, baby. For me?" Adora asks, right in Catra's ear. Her body covers Catra's and they're so intertwined that Adora's heart finally starts to feel at peace after a long and hectic day. She thinks, for a second, that if the roles were reversed she would have probably cum already.

"Mhm," Catra nods the best that she can, and Adora breathes out again, hot on her neck.

The flat of her tongue runs over the pads of those fingers, and Adora keeps up a gentle thrusting into her mouth. It's not enough to reach her throat, but it is enough for Catra to feel the rough ridges of those digits massaging at her tongue.

Catra is certain she'll go crazy at the feeling. Saliva runs down her chin as she gets a little more enthusiastic with her sucking. It makes Adora curse under her breath.

Pressing her body closer so their thumping hearts are mere centimeters apart, Adora gives herself over to the need she's felt all night. She lets herself need Catra, lets herself desire her. And if there was one thing that Adora knew, it was that she wanted Catra with her whole being, with her whole heart, with every nerve ending in her body.

She needs Catra. Like she couldn’t breathe without her, Adora inhales all that Catra’s body has to offer her.

Adora is going to destroy her. She’s going to decimate that which she holds dearest so that Catra, like a phoenix, rises from the ashes of the temple of her body and lives anew with the feeling of being loved and desired seared into her.

Fingers withdraw from Catra’s mouth, slowly running down her chin and to her neck. She feels the filthy sensation of those fingers slipping to the top of her own tank top and just registers that her other hand is no longer teasing at the edge of her pussy. And it's in that realization that Catra feels the thin fabric give and the sound of the material tearing as Adora rips the tank top straight down the middle. Catra doesn’t even have time to complain before she’s choking on her own breath. Adora has leaned down, parting the now loose tatters of her top, and nudges one of her breasts with her nose.

“Adora?” Catra asks, and it gains a thoughtful look from her wife. Those blue eyes staring back at her.

“Take me to bed.”

It’s not a suggestion, it's not a request. It’s a fucking order.

And Adora thrived on following her executive chef’s orders.

“Yes Chef.”

They drag each other by shirt collar and wrist to the bedroom.

“Fuck, just like that,” Catra pants, laying her head back on the pillow, gripping Adora’s white chef coat as the other woman lays her down. She descends to Catra’s mound, kissing around her swollen clit.

“You hungry sweetheart?” Catra jokes, trying to gain back some of the control over the situation she’d lost.

"Yes Chef, starving," Adora responds.

And it's the stupidest thing, something that makes both of them burst into giggles.

"How many minutes out on that orgasm?" Catra jokes.

"Two minutes to the window, Chef."

"Two minutes? You think I'm that desperate?" Catra rolls her eyes.

Adora's times were *never* off. Every risotto, every filet, every piece of fish. When Adora said they were two minutes out, she meant it. And Catra never doubted Adora's timing.

So maybe it was time to buckle up and let Adora show her how things are done.

After all, though Adora was technically her second in the kitchen, Catra knew that she had skill that rivaled her own.

"Two minutes, Chef."

It's the last thing Adora says before she dives in, running her tongue through Catra's folds and reaching one hand up to cup her breast. It's all Catra can do to hold her tongue, not wanting to give Adora the satisfaction of being *right* about the 'two minutes' thing. But she was just so fucking good with her tongue.

Adora had dedicated most of her life perfecting her culinary skills. Days and nights working hard in the test kitchen at their institute, coming home to do more of the same in her own apartment. But if there was one thing that Adora knew better than cooking, it was how to make Catra feel good.

If there was one thing she'd give up her culinary dreams for, it would be the chance to eat Catra out all day, every day.

Sharp nails dig into her scalp as Adora plants her mouth, wide and open, over Catra's wetness. She sucks on her clit and brings a

hand up to dig into her thighs.

"That's it- *shit* ," Catra starts, but she's cut off by teeth digging into her thigh as two fingers plunge deep and quickly into her tight core. Adora's fingers curl up into Catra's soft walls, relishing in the deep and intimate way that those muscles contract and pull her further in.

It takes all that Catra has in her to hold on while Adora's fingers start thrusting in and out in a rhythmic motion. They slide into her easily, roughly, and curl on their way out. It's driving Catra absolutely mad to have this much happening to her; the fingers in her, the tongue on her clit, the other hand pinching her nipple.

The attack to her senses is made more severe by the onslaught of emotion that took her.

Catra gets to lay here and have the most beautiful woman in the world do the most intimate thing she could think of. It was hard to let this happen, to let Adora have her way with her. But in the end, it would only ever be her and Adora, up in this apartment where they were safe from the world, where they got to be themselves.

The way they're talking to each other is so fucking ridiculous, too. Like, sure, she'd spent the night thinking about Adora eating her out on the black quartz counter of *her* bar in *her* restaurant. She'd spent the night watching Adora's wrist as she flicked it, tossing the contents of a sauté pan with lavish flair. She watched that hair, tied up in a bun and out of the way, and dreamt of running her fingers through golden strands.

She dreamt of the moment Adora had her fun and let Catra take over, and that was something she couldn't wait for anymore.

The thought of that, of what she was going to do to Adora next, is met with the rushing feeling of her orgasm taking her. She clenches on Adora's fingers, her thighs straining to keep up with the motion of her hips.

Panting, Catra says triumphantly, “That was four minutes and garnish died in the window waiting for you. Refire one orgasm, urgently.”

Adora throws her head back laughing. She didn’t know when Catra had a chance to look at her watch, but it must have been when Adora had decided to forgo eye contact and go to town on her pussy.

“Yes Chef,” Adora chuckles low in her throat.

But as she leans down to kiss Catra’s stomach, the woman below her laughs too.

Adora’s eyes trail up and make contact with Catra’s, that air of mischief shimmering, and she knows that whatever is about to happen, she isn’t the one on top anymore.

She isn’t the one in control.

Catra wraps her legs around Adora’s middle, under her arms, and it's with all of her strength that she flips them roughly. Adora’s shocked gasp at the sudden movement is met with a little giggle from Catra, one that means she’s about to cause some trouble.

Adora knew Catra pretty damn well. She knew her well enough to know that she *loved* causing a little trouble now and then.

“You know, sometimes if you want something done right, in a timely manner, you have to take matters into your own hands,” Catra’s voice has lightened, the teasing lilt to each syllable affecting Adora way more than they should. But this was Catra, and everything about Catra turned her on.

So why not the ever so slight air of mockery and embarrassment? It couldn’t be helped.

“Are you going to show me how it’s done? You gonna take me back to culinary school?”

" *Psh* , being a flirt won't get you anywhere," Catra says, crawling down Adora's body and grabbing her hands to guide them up to the headboard. She gets the hint and grabs the wooden slats, and Catra's fingers tickle down her wrists and forearms until she gets to the thick material of her chef coat and that is when hands turn desperate.

"Someone has to flirt with you."

"Hush now, *monsieur sous chef* , the executive chef is talking."

"Woooow." Adora's reply is long and drawn out, but in her attempt to be offended, Catra's finger slips to her lips to shush her.

Adora takes the tip in her mouth and nibbles on it, causing Catra to giggle and withdraw her hand. She grabs Adora's chin, the squared jawline fitting perfectly in her hand, and draws her attention upward.

"There she is, there are those eyes," Catra whispers, catching Adora's gaze in her own captivating way.

Adora's hands tighten on the slats of the wooden headboard.

And Catra is a whirlwind. She's touching, groping, everything she can reach, everything she can think to touch. She's in and all over Adora, and there isn't a lot she can do to keep sane when things are this heated, when Catra is touching her like this.

Adora feels loved and cherished and everything wonderful she's supposed to feel when she's with her wife, and she feels it so strongly and violently that a tear escapes her eye to trickle down her cheek. If Catra notices she doesn't say anything, because there had been plenty of times that she'd cried during sex and simply needed to be held after. So, Catra keeps going.

She doesn't stop.

She never would.

Not as long as Adora wanted, needed her.

Catra makes love to her wife like Adora is the only thing that can keep her head above water, the only thing that can ground her and make her feel the way she longs to feel. Catra makes love to her wife like she'll go mad without the taste of Adora on her tongue, the feel of that slickness on her lips. She makes love to her wife, because there was nothing she wanted to do more.

And when Adora's orgasm takes her, the wave is forceful and brutal, washing her away and bringing her back in with just enough strength to grip Catra's shoulder for stability and support.

"There's my good girl. That's it," Catra says, thrusting fingers and probing tongue working Adora through her peak and back down again, panting.

Catra crawls up Adora's body, trailing kisses in her wake until she reaches Adora's lips and presses theirs together.

They cuddle for a while, intertwined with each other, but soon enough it's time to get ready for bed. At the very least, they need to throw their chef coats and work pants in the wash before they head into the restaurant tomorrow. It was going to be an early day. Not only did they open earlier on Saturdays, but it was the city's famed Restaurant Week and they had a few specials that had been extremely popular.

Catra is the first to get up.

"Come on baby, let's get cleaned up," She says, tugging at Adora's arm. It's just enough to get her wife to sit up and slide off of the bed, though her legs groan in protest.

"But I wanna go to bed," Adora whines. Catra can't blame her.

"We can go to bed once we're cleaned up and have had something to eat, k?

If their shared shower takes longer than it should, well, who could blame them?

Catra departs the shower first, letting Adora relish in the comforting heat while she makes them a snack before bed. She grabs a few slices of leftover pizza from lunch the other day, tops it with more fresh mozzarella and basil, and slides it into their toaster oven to crisp up. While that is reheating, she grabs some leftover pesto from the fridge and brings it back to life with an extra drizzle of olive oil and some fresh grated parmesan. Just as she's spreading a couple of tablespoons of the pesto over their freshly reheated pizza, Adora comes out of the bedroom and heads to the liquor cabinet in the alcove next to the TV.

They meet each other halfway. Adora pours two fingers of whiskey into a rocks glass for Catra and mixes herself a little nightcap of Kahlua and Baileys. Catra sets the plate of pizza down on the kitchen table for them to share and when they both slide into chairs, they lean over the center of the table to press a brief kiss to each other's lips.

Catra sips her whiskey, leaning back in her chair with a slice in one hand and her rocks glass in the other. They're the monogrammed ones that Catra's father got them as an engagement present, and her eyes roam from her own glass's acid etched "C" to Adora's "A."

Just like that, they're back to that first night in culinary school, when Adora brought her home and they cooked dinner together instead of against each other. And just like that, Catra is thinking that there really was no motherfucker on earth luckier than she was.

She had her dream of the restaurant, she had her dream of Adora being her wife.

And she would live those dreams for the rest of her life.

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